

Face2Face

Olga Hamilton, Landon Pugh, and Brandon Verbick

Creative Challenge

Young adults today struggle with in-person interactions and their communication skills.

How can we solve this?

- Ask students (young adults) about their communication skills
- Determine what they believe helps them improve
- Design a solution that helps people improve face-to-face interaction

Interviews

We interviewed 12 BAU students to gather a consensus on what activities and processes help them improve.

1. On a scale of 1-10, how confident do you feel about your ability to engage comfortably in face-to-face conversations? Explain your rating briefly.
2. Do you think frequent use of social media and technology affects your ability to communicate effectively with others in person? Why or why not?
3. What specific challenges or discomforts do you experience when interacting face-to-face, especially when meeting new people or in unfamiliar settings?
4. Do you tend to intentionally avoid in-person interactions by using technology or social media instead?
5. Do you feel lonely or disconnected due to over reliance on digital communication (texts, social media, etc.)? Provide an example if so.
6. What type of activities or support do you think would help improve your in-person communication skills?
7. What experiences or factors in your life have most strongly shaped your current level of confidence in communicating face-to-face (family, schooling, peer experiences)?
8. In your opinion, how can your University create a campus environment that encourages and strengthens meaningful, face-to-face interactions among students?
9. Do you believe that improved interpersonal skills would positively impact your academic performance, career opportunities, or social life? Please elaborate.
10. What is one piece of advice or strategy you would give to peers who feel overly dependent on social media and technology for social interactions?
11. What is your preferred method of communication?
12. How confident do you feel when communicating

Key Insights

Over Reliance on Social Media

Many students expressed that they believe the presence of social media damages their communication.

- Avoiding “awkward” conversations
- “Easier” communication
- More relaxed
- Distant from confrontation

Improvement comes from experience

Students shared that their current communication skills improved from activities that required them to interact with new people (school, sports, projects, etc.)

- People interact more in pre-arranged scenarios
- Not having to plan an event or activity increases likelihood of participation

Key Insights

People prefer to talk to those similar to them

Students shared that they are most comfortable talking to peers and those with similar interests to them.

- Having common interests create easygoing conversations that are enjoyable

Students recognize their limits and wish to improve their skills

Throughout all interviews, no matter people's confidence, there was a desire to improve their communication skills.

- Useful for future endeavors
- Overall improvements to quality of day-to-day life

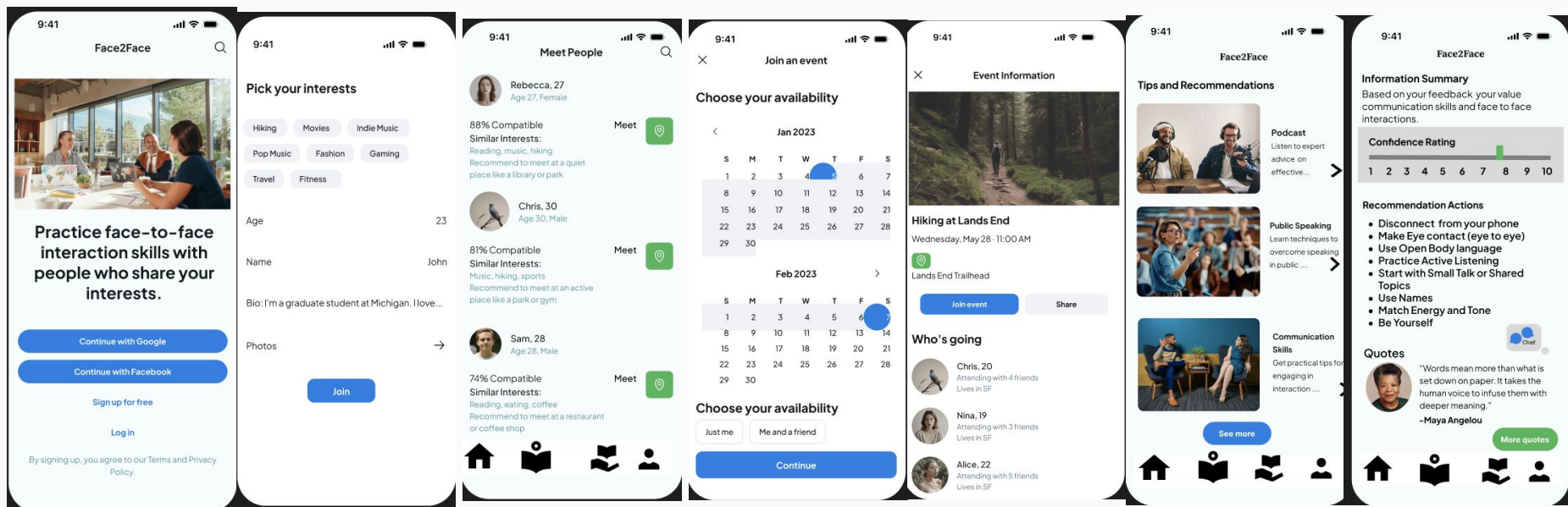
Our Solution

Face2Face

An app designed to facilitate activities with new people based on user's interests and preferences.

User's create a profile with their interests, fill out their availability, and are matched with a random group of people and assigned a public location to meet each other.

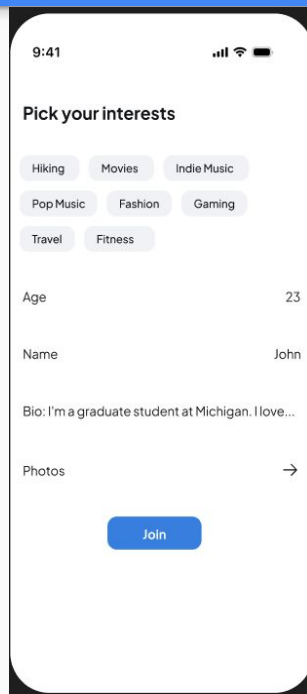
Prototype 1



Key Features

Profile Setup

Users enter their interests, age, photos, and a short bio about themselves to help get an accurate matchup.



A mobile app interface for profile setup. At the top, the status bar shows the time 9:41, signal strength, Wi-Fi, and battery. The main heading is "Pick your interests". Below it are eight interest tags: Hiking, Movies, Indie Music, Pop Music, Fashion, Gaming, Travel, and Fitness. The form includes fields for Age (23), Name (John), Bio (I'm a graduate student at Michigan. I love...), and Photos (indicated by a right arrow). A blue "Join" button is at the bottom.

9:41

Pick your interests

Hiking Movies Indie Music

Pop Music Fashion Gaming

Travel Fitness

Age 23

Name John

Bio: I'm a graduate student at Michigan. I love...

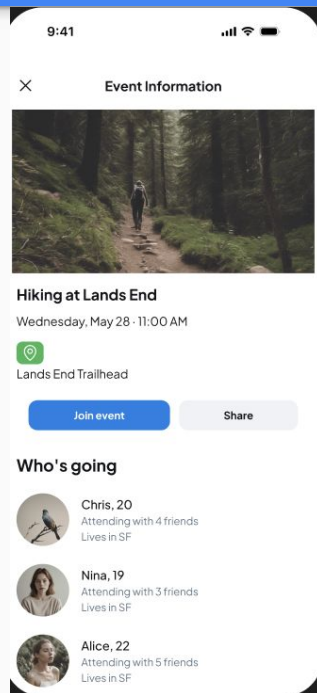
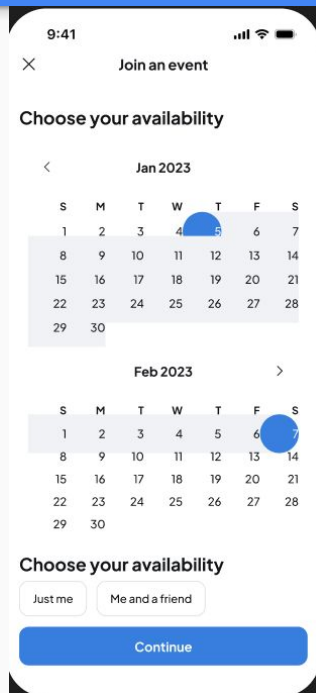
Photos →

Join

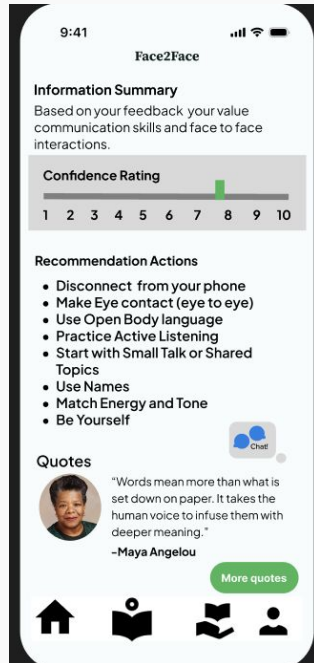
Key Features

Joining Events

Users select dates and times they are free, and are randomly assigned to an event that isn't known to them when signing up. Information about the location, time, and people attending the event are then revealed.



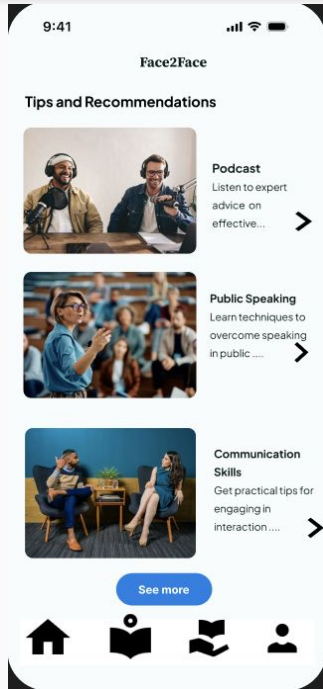
Key Features



Event Feedback

After an event, users rate their experience and confidence level, which will help assign them to future events based on their enjoyment.

Key Features



Informational Material

There is a tab dedicated to helping users become more comfortable socializing, featuring articles, videos, and podcasts.

First Round of Feedback

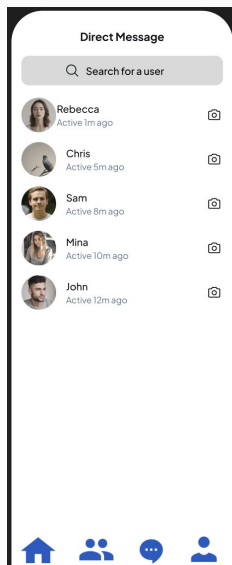
We showed our prototype to 12 BAU students and asked them what we could improve upon.

A common area of the suggestions were around the pre-event process. Some examples are:

- Adding in a direct messaging/video call feature
- Being able to make custom events and group sizes
- More advanced descriptions when creating a profile

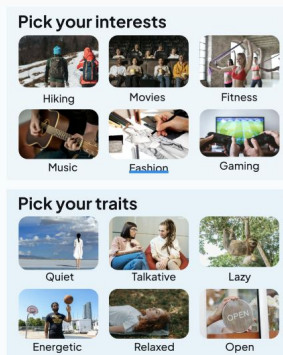
Revisions

Direct Messaging



UI Changes

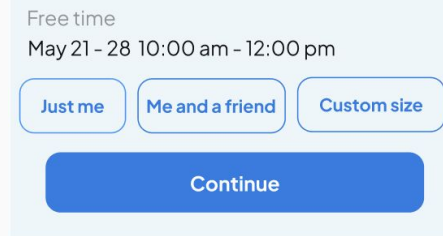
Added photos to various places on the app for better user experience



Ability to Decline



Custom Group Sizes



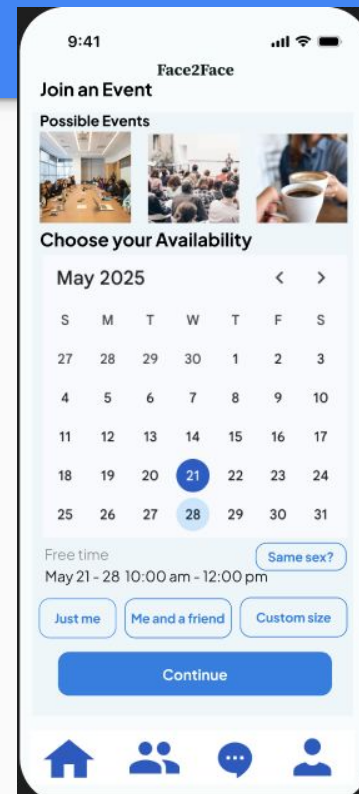
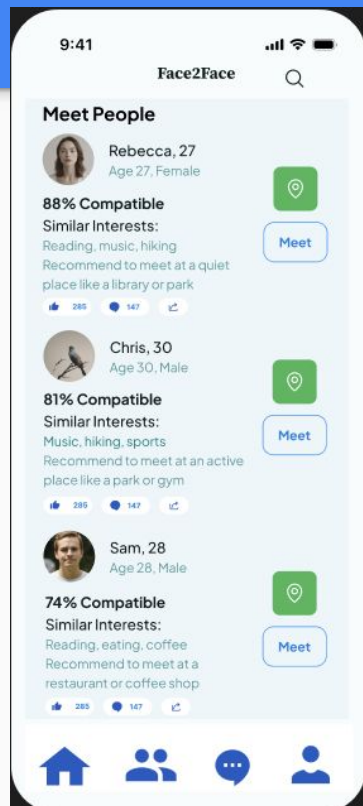
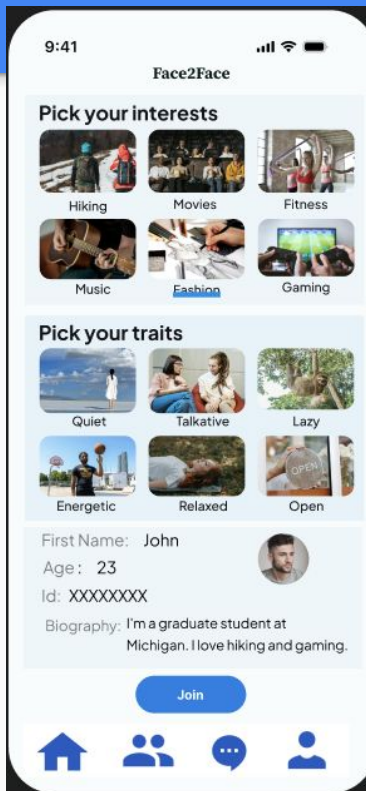
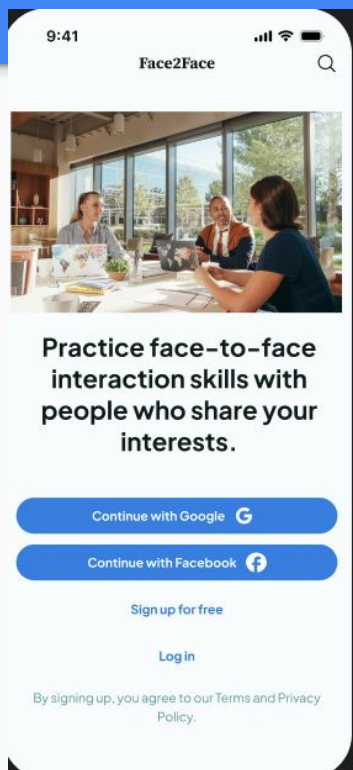
Second Round of Feedback

We showed our prototype to 5 more BAU students and asked if we needed any final revisions.

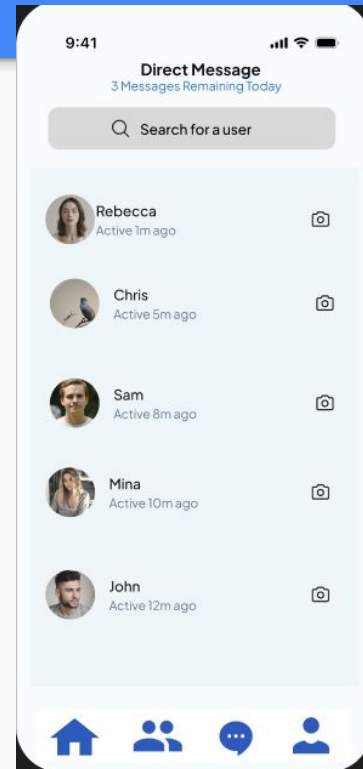
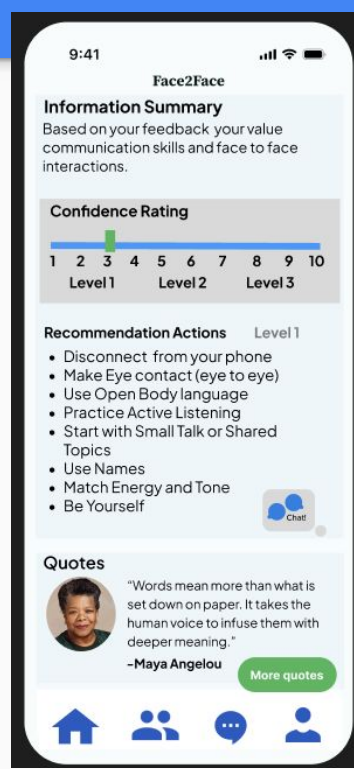
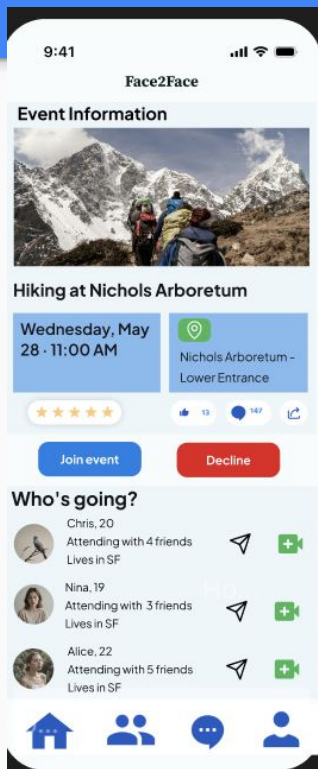
Overall people liked the app and had few recommendations for changes.

- Option for same-sex meetups
- Limit direct messages

Final Prototype



Final Prototype



Future Ideas

If we were to continue working on this project, there are a few other ideas we could implement:

- A premium membership where you pay a monthly fee that allows you to get into more premier events, such as a paid entry tech conference.
- Implement a way for users to suggest or create their own events in a safe way
- Entrepreneurial version for users to ask for certain skill sets for their business ideas

Figma Link

Figma